sent the first of many diplomatic notes to the Ministry of External Affairs.

> According to a report received from the Tibet Region of China, over thirty Indian troops armed with rifles crossed the Niti Pass on 29 June 1954, and intruded into Wu-Je [Barahoti] of the Ali Area of the Tibet Region of China. [Wu-Je is about one day's journey from the Niti Pass.] The above happening is not in conformity with the principles of non-aggression and friendly co-existence between China and India, and the spirit of the Joint Communiqué issued recently by the Prime Ministers of China and India. It is hoped that the Government of India would promptly investigate the matter, and order the immediate withdrawal of the Indian troops in question from the above-mentioned territory of the Tibet Region of China. We shall appreciate it if you will let us know at the earliest opportunity the results of steps which you are to take in the above matter.'

On 13 August, even before the Indians had replied, the consul was back with more details of the alleged Wu-Je incident:

> I am to inform you that further investigations reveal that they were a unit of 33 persons attached to the local garrison in U.P., India. The unit was under the command of an officer called *Nathauje* who was a deputy commander of the troops stationing at *Kanman*. Together with the officer, there was a local official named *Sopit Singh* of *Chinal* tribe in U.P., who was also a district magistrate of *Walzanjapur* district. Besides, there were a doctor, radio-operators and soldiers. They were putting up in 17 tents.

It signed off with the same lines about the principles of non-aggression and the spirit of the joint communiqué issued by the two prime ministers.

On 27 August, the Indians replied, denying any such infringement on their part. Countering the allegation, they also made the accusation that Tibetan officials had crossed into Indian territory, and asked China to ensure that this violation was not repeated.

The paper war had begun. Accusations and counter-accusations kept the consulates in New Delhi and Peking very busy.

Thirteen months later, it was the Indians who forwarded a note on 28 June 1955: 'We have now received a report that a party of Chinese are camping at Hoti with 5 tents and 20 horses and that they have entered our territory without proper documents.' They asked once again that China withdraw these troops immediately and refrain from entering Indian territory.

Till mid-1956, the bone of contention was the Barahoti (Wu-Je) region. On 2 May, India objected to the presence of a Chinese officer with twelve men equipped with 'tommy and Sten guns and telescopes' in the Tsang Chok-la area. Then again on 1 September 1956 'a party of about 10 Chinese Army personnel entered and took up positions about 2 furlongs from Hupsong Khad on the Indian side of Shipki-la'.